

The look and feel is that of working on a Desktop application, and only the persistent lag of responses over the Net gives any indication that the software is actually being delivered over the Web.

Most of the features you would expect from a Desktop office productivity suite like MS Word or Open Office Writer is available in Zoho Writer. However, for heavily-formatted documents, it is better to rely on one primary application, as formatting tends to get skewed when you move documents between formats. This problem, while not peculiar to Zoho, will also surface when you work with documents using the MS Word plugin. Ideally, for presentation-grade documents that you wish to distribute to a formal audience, you should start and finish your work from within Zoho Writer itself. This caveat is applicable to Zoho Sheets and Show as well.

You can make your documents public, share them via e-mail, publish them to your blog, or include them in a “Doc Roll” on your Web site or blog. The Doc Roll is similar to the Blog Roll that you would include on your blog. Documents that are made public are not editable, but you can permit visitors to post comments. A specific URL will be given that can be accessed by anyone. Shared documents can, however, only be viewed by those you invite. If they have a Zoho account, and you’ve given them permission, they will be able to edit the documents. If they don’t have a Zoho account, they will only be able to view the documents, and will need to sign up to be able to edit them. You can also start a chat session (using Zoho Chat) right within the same window to discuss the document with those who you’ve invited to share it.

Also, you can tag the documents with specific labels, which can be useful for sorting and retrieval later. One useful feature is the automatic versioning of documents, which enables you to roll back and compare various versions of the document that have been saved over a period of time. Thus, you can compare between two different versions and revert to an earlier version if required. A link that enables you to e-mail the document to your colleagues